

## 2<sup>nd</sup> Year English - CBA Preparation

For your CBA, you have to give a performance in front of an audience. You have three choices to choose from:

1. Give a speech or talk about something you're passionate about
2. Perform a monologue
3. Recite a poem

### Stages of Writing a Speech

#### Stage One - Come up with an idea

Brainstorm as many ideas as possible. When you have decided a topic, create a mind map of all the possible things you could talk about. Try to come up with as many ideas as possible, as this will give you more options later on when you begin writing your speech.

#### Stage Two - Plan your speech

Think about what order you will talk about things in your speech. If you're giving a speech about homelessness, your plan could look like this:

|                 |                                      |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------|
| Paragraph One   | Introduce yourself                   |
| Paragraph Two   | Define homelessness (use statistics) |
| Paragraph Three | Impact of homelessness on society    |
| Paragraph Four  | Homeless services in Ireland         |
| Paragraph Five  | Potential solutions/ways to help     |
| Paragraph Six   | Conclusion - summarise arguments     |

#### Stage Three - Write your first draft

- You should begin writing your speech for the first time.
- You should try to make your speech as long as possible, to ensure you have enough to talk about for three minutes.
- When you have finished your first draft, you will need to read through it to see if there are any places you can improve the speech.
- You can let your friend read your speech to see if there are any places they think you can improve it.
- You will also need to time yourself reading the speech. Are you over or under the three minutes? For the speech, you will not be penalised for going 30 seconds over the time limit, or 30 seconds under.
  - If you are way short, you will need to add another paragraph in your second draft
  - If you are over the time limit, you will need to shorten your second draft

#### Stage Four - Write your second draft

When you have figured ways to improve your speech, you will write your speech again. Use the speech writing checklist to ensure you have used all of the necessary techniques and features of a speech. You can write your speech in your copy, refill pad or type it out to make it easier to read.

#### Stage Five - Practice reading your speech

Familiarise yourself with your speech by reading it over and over again. Try to practice in front of your friends to get used to speaking aloud.



### Stage Six - Create a PowerPoint/background for your speech (optional)

If you want to create a PowerPoint or visual to go with your presentation, you can do so.

### Stages of Performing a Monologue or Reciting a Poem

If you are performing a monologue or reciting a poem, you will need to write a short introduction to your piece. You have complete freedom as to what you talk about. However, most people will probably talk about the themes or message of the poem and why they're relevant or important to you. It could also just be outlining why you enjoy the monologue or piece of writing.

#### An example of a structure for a monologue or poem

| Monologue                                                                                                  | Reciting a poem                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Why you chose this piece                                                                                | 1. Discuss a theme of the poem                                                  |
| 2. Explain the context of the speech<br>- what has just happened in the story<br>to justify the monologue? | 2. Introduce the poem and poet.<br>Why and when did the poet write<br>the poem. |
| 3. Perform the monologue                                                                                   | 3. Recite the poem                                                              |
| 4. Discuss the import message/theme<br>of the monologue                                                    | 4. Explain why the poem is<br>important to you                                  |

Obviously the length of your introduction and analyse of the monologue/poem will depend on the length of what you are recite. Try to aim for a maximum of  $3\frac{1}{2}$  minutes, as you will need 30 seconds to answer questions at the end.

You will need to draft and redraft your script to ensure it is within the time limit, and you are satisfied with the quality of what you're saying.

### Practicing the Monologue/Poem

- In order to perform a monologue or recite a poem, you will need to practice. Try to practice in front of your friends or family, to get used to an audience.
- Try to experiment with different ways of saying reciting it. Many sentences can have different meanings depending on which words you emphasise, so try reciting it in different ways.
- Record yourself and listen to yourself reciting the piece over and over again. It'll help the words seep into your brain.
- As terrifying as it sounds, you should also film yourself reciting the piece. Watch your body language and try to find ways to improve it. Will you gesture throughout the performance? Will you sit down or stand up? Do you want to use props? The more confident you pretend to be, the more confident the audience will believe you are and it'll look superb.

**CBA Checklist**

Name:

Oisín Argand

**For a Speech:**

1. I have come up with my idea. ☐
2. I have created a plan for my speech ☐
3. I have written my first draft ☐
4. I have reread my first draft and found for ways to improve it ☐
5. I have timed the length of my first draft ☐
6. I have rewritten my speech and made the changes to improve it ☐
7. I have timed the length of my second draft ☐
8. I have practiced reading the speech ☐
9. I have written or typed my speech neatly so I can read it ☐
10. I have created a PowerPoint/background for my presentation (optional) ☐

**For a monologue or reciting a poem**

1. I have chosen my piece to recite ☒
2. I have planned out my discussion before and after the recitation ☒
3. I have written my first draft of my discussion ☒
4. I have timed the length of my first draft ☒
5. I have reread my first draft and found for ways to improve it ☒
6. I have rewritten my speech and made the changes to improve it ☒
7. I have timed the length of my second draft ☒
8. I have practiced my monologue/poem and discussion ☐



# Speech Writing Checklist

## Introduction:

- ☐ Introduced myself and greeted the audience.
- ☐ Grabbed audience's attention to draw them in to the speech.
- ☐ Strongly stated my main/overall point of view.
- ☐ Asked a rhetorical question and mentioned the points I will talk about.

## Body:

- ☐ Have one paragraph for each of my points.
- ☐ Mentioned at least one point of view that is different to mine (contrast).
- ☐ Connected each paragraph in the body of my speech to the previous paragraph.
- ☐ Paragraphs follow a logical structure and I relate my points back to my main view.
- ☐ Used evidence (facts or statistics) to back up my points.  
*(If primarily appealing to reason and using logic/evidence = argumentative writing.)*
- ☐ Appealed to audience's feelings by using emotional language/imagery or an anecdote.  
*(If primarily appealing to emotions to change opinion = persuasive writing.)*
- ☐ Have a powerful phrase which I repeat.
- ☐ Used repetition and rhetorical questions.
- ☐ Used at least one of the following:  
alliteration, humour/hyperbole, metaphors, similes, quotes.
- ☐ Conveyed a sense of necessity/urgency (e.g. series of short sentences).
- ☐ Used words like 'I', 'we', 'our' and 'you' to directly connect with and include the audience.

## Conclusion:

- ☐ Comes to a conclusion which has been given weight by the body of my speech.
- ☐ Summarised the points in my speech.
- ☐ Thanked the audience for listening and appealed to them once more (asking them to think about what was said or asking a rhetorical question).